Current Affairs 2026

One Hundred Questions for CLAT 2027 | 100 questions | 100 marks | 45 minutes

INSTRUCTIONS

This booklet contains 100 multiple-choice questions on current affairs of 2026, arranged in seven themes. Every question carries one mark, and there is no negative marking.

The questions cover January to November 2026, with a few items from late 2025 that remain relevant. Where a question tests a static fact linked to a 2026 event, that is stated in the theme heading.

Suggested time is 45 minutes, giving about 27 seconds a question. The answer key and a one-line explanation for each question follow the paper.

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A. POLITY, GOVERNANCE AND APPOINTMENTS

1. Who took charge as the Chief of Defence Staff in May 2026?

(A) General Dhiraj Seth
(B) General N. S. Raja Subramani
(C) Admiral Krishna Swaminathan
(D) Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit

2. Who was appointed Chief of the Air Staff in October 2026?

(A) Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit
(B) Air Marshal R. K. S. Bhadauria
(C) Air Chief Marshal A. P. Singh
(D) Air Chief Marshal V. R. Chaudhari

3. Who is the Chief of the Naval Staff, who took charge on 31 May 2026?

(A) Admiral R. Hari Kumar
(B) Admiral Karambir Singh
(C) Admiral Dinesh K. Tripathi
(D) Admiral Krishna Swaminathan

4. Who is the Chief of the Army Staff of India?

(A) General Upendra Dwivedi
(B) General Manoj Pande
(C) General Dhiraj Seth
(D) General M. M. Naravane

5. Who is the Chief Justice of India?

(A) Justice Surya Kant
(B) Justice Hrishikesh Roy
(C) Justice Sanjiv Khanna
(D) Justice B. R. Gavai

6. Who is the Governor of the Reserve Bank of India?

(A) Shaktikanta Das
(B) Sanjay Malhotra
(C) Urjit Patel
(D) Michael Patra

7. Who is the Chief Election Commissioner of India?

(A) Sukhbir Singh Sandhu
(B) Anup Chandra Pandey
(C) Rajiv Kumar
(D) Gyanesh Kumar

8. The Sixteenth Finance Commission, whose recommendations were accepted in the 2026-27 Budget, is chaired by:

(A) Arvind Panagariya
(B) Y. V. Reddy
(C) Vijay Kelkar
(D) N. K. Singh

9. In the 2026 Assembly elections, who became the first Bharatiya Janata Party Chief Minister of West Bengal?

(A) Suvendu Adhikari
(B) Sukanta Majumdar
(C) Mithun Chakraborty
(D) Dilip Ghosh

10. Who became Chief Minister of Tamil Nadu in May 2026?

(A) M. K. Stalin
(B) Edappadi K. Palaniswami
(C) C. Joseph Vijay
(D) Udhayanidhi Stalin

11. The 2026 Assembly elections were held in four States and one Union Territory. Which of the following was NOT among them?

(A) West Bengal
(B) Kerala
(C) Assam
(D) Karnataka

12. In Kerala, the 2026 Assembly election produced a change of government in favour of:

(A) the National Democratic Alliance
(B) a hung assembly
(C) the Left Democratic Front
(D) the United Democratic Front

13. Himanta Biswa Sarma's return as Chief Minister of Assam in 2026 was notable because he became:

(A) the first non-Congress leader to return for a second consecutive term
(B) the first Chief Minister to be elected unopposed
(C) the first Chief Minister from the Barak Valley
(D) the youngest Chief Minister of the State

14. Census 2027 will be conducted under which statute?

(A) The Census Act, 1948
(B) The Citizenship Act, 1955
(C) The Registration of Births and Deaths Act, 1969
(D) The Statistics Act, 2008

15. The reference date, or census moment, for Census 2027 is:

(A) 00:00 hours on 1 April 2027
(B) 00:00 hours on 1 October 2026
(C) 00:00 hours on 1 January 2027
(D) 00:00 hours on 1 March 2027

16. The mascots unveiled for Census 2027 are:

(A) Pragati and Vikas
(B) Sakhi and Sarthi
(C) Disha and Drishti
(D) Ginti and Ganak

17. Caste enumeration in Census 2027 was decided by:

(A) the Union Cabinet
(B) the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs
(C) the Registrar General of India
(D) the Supreme Court

18. Census 2027 will be India's first census conducted:

(A) by an independent agency
(B) in a single phase
(C) using paper schedules since 1948
(D) by digital means, with an option of self-enumeration

19. The GST Council is a constitutional body created by which amendment?

(A) The 102nd Amendment
(B) The 103rd Amendment
(C) The 100th Amendment
(D) The 101st Amendment

20. Who is the Vice-President of India?

(A) Hamid Ansari
(B) Jagdeep Dhankhar
(C) C. P. Radhakrishnan
(D) M. Venkaiah Naidu

B. ECONOMY AND FINANCE

21. At its meeting in October 2026, the Monetary Policy Committee raised the repo rate by 25 basis points to:

(A) 5.50 per cent
(B) 6.00 per cent
(C) 6.50 per cent
(D) 5.25 per cent

22. What stance did the Monetary Policy Committee adopt in October 2026?

(A) Neutral
(B) Calibrated tightening
(C) Withdrawal of accommodation
(D) Accommodative

23. Following the October 2026 decision, the Standing Deposit Facility rate stands at:

(A) 5.50 per cent
(B) 5.75 per cent
(C) 5.00 per cent
(D) 5.25 per cent

24. Real GDP growth in the first quarter of 2026-27, as estimated by the National Statistical Office, was:

(A) 7.8 per cent
(B) 8.2 per cent
(C) 6.5 per cent
(D) 7.1 per cent

25. In October 2026 the RBI projected GDP growth for 2026-27 at:

(A) 7.1 per cent
(B) 7.6 per cent
(C) 6.5 per cent
(D) 6.8 per cent

26. India's foreign exchange reserves stood at approximately which level in early October 2026?

(A) USD 684 billion
(B) USD 734 billion
(C) USD 834 billion
(D) USD 634 billion

27. The fiscal deficit in the Budget Estimates for 2026-27 was placed at:

(A) 4.9 per cent of GDP
(B) 4.0 per cent of GDP
(C) 4.3 per cent of GDP
(D) 4.4 per cent of GDP

28. Public capital expenditure in the 2026-27 Budget was raised to:

(A) Rs. 13.5 lakh crore
(B) Rs. 10.2 lakh crore
(C) Rs. 11.2 lakh crore
(D) Rs. 12.2 lakh crore

29. The debt-to-GDP ratio estimated in the 2026-27 Budget, against which the government has set a glide path, is:

(A) 50.1 per cent
(B) 53.4 per cent
(C) 55.6 per cent
(D) 58.2 per cent

30. The 2026-27 Budget retained the States' vertical share of central taxes at:

(A) 45 per cent
(B) 32 per cent
(C) 41 per cent
(D) 42 per cent

31. Which of the following was among the seven High-Speed Rail corridors announced in the 2026-27 Budget?

(A) Kolkata-Chennai
(B) Bengaluru-Mumbai
(C) Delhi-Mumbai
(D) Mumbai-Pune

32. NW-5, the first of twenty new National Waterways to be operationalised, is in:

(A) Assam
(B) West Bengal
(C) Odisha
(D) Andhra Pradesh

33. At its 57th meeting in October 2026, the GST Council recommended:

(A) the merger of CGST and SGST laws
(B) a reduction in the number of tax slabs
(C) the withdrawal of the power to arrest under GST
(D) an increase in the general penalty

34. The monetary threshold for launching prosecution under GST was raised to:

(A) Rs. 5 crore
(B) Rs. 10 crore
(C) Rs. 20 crore
(D) Rs. 2 crore

35. The general penalty under section 125 of the CGST Act was reduced from Rs. 25,000 to:

(A) Rs. 5,000
(B) Rs. 10,000
(C) Rs. 15,000
(D) Rs. 20,000

36. The GST Council decided that changes to GST rates would be considered:

(A) only during the Budget session
(B) every quarter
(C) twice a year
(D) once a year

37. The time allowed for acknowledging a GST refund claim was reduced from 15 days to:

(A) 12 days
(B) 14 days
(C) 7 days
(D) 10 days

38. The Union Budget 2026-27 was the first Budget prepared in:

(A) North Block
(B) Kartavya Bhawan
(C) Yojana Bhawan
(D) Vanijya Bhawan

39. India's coastal shipping and inland waterways share of cargo movement is to be raised from 6 per cent to 12 per cent by:

(A) 2030
(B) 2035
(C) 2040
(D) 2047

40. The Union Budget for 2026-27 was presented on 1 February 2026 by:

(A) Nirmala Sitharaman
(B) Piyush Goyal
(C) Amit Shah
(D) Nitin Gadkari

C. INTERNATIONAL AFFAIRS AND SUMMITS

41. The 18th BRICS Summit was held in September 2026 at:
(A) Rio de Janeiro
(B) Bharat Mandapam, New Delhi
(C) Kazan
(D) Johannesburg

42. India's BRICS chairship in 2026 was its:
(A) second
(B) third
(C) fourth
(D) fifth

43. The theme of India's BRICS chairship in 2026 was:
(A) Towards a Fair and Equitable World Order
(B) Building for Resilience, Innovation, Cooperation and Sustainability
(C) Strengthening Multilateralism for Just Global Development
(D) Partnership for Global Development and Security

44. The 2026 BRICS Summit concluded with the adoption of the:
(A) Johannesburg Declaration
(B) New Delhi Declaration
(C) Rio Declaration
(D) Kazan Declaration

45. COP31, the UN climate conference of 2026, is being held from 9 to 20 November 2026 in:
(A) Antalya, Turkiye
(B) Belem, Brazil
(C) Dubai, UAE
(D) Baku, Azerbaijan

46. The President of COP31 is:
(A) Antonio Guterres
(B) Murat Kurum of Turkiye
(C) Chris Bowen of Australia
(D) Simon Stiell

47. Which country is leading the negotiations at COP31, working with Pacific island countries?
(A) Fiji
(B) Japan
(C) Australia
(D) New Zealand

48. The 2026 summit of the Shanghai Cooperation Organisation was held in:
(A) Astana
(B) Samarkand
(C) Bishkek
(D) Tianjin

49. The President of the 81st session of the UN General Assembly is:
(A) Khalilur Rahman
(B) Philémon Yang
(C) Csaba Korosi
(D) Abdulla Shahid

50. Who is the Chair of the United States Federal Reserve?

(A) Janet Yellen
(B) Lael Brainard
(C) Jerome Powell
(D) Kevin Warsh

51. The President of the Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank, who took office in January 2026, is:

(A) Danny Alexander
(B) Joachim von Amsberg
(C) Jin Liqun
(D) Zou Jiayi

52. The India AI Impact Summit, held in New Delhi in February 2026, concluded with a declaration endorsed by:

(A) 88 countries and organisations
(B) 120 countries
(C) 28 countries
(D) 50 countries

53. The 2026 FIFA World Cup was the first to be hosted by:

(A) four countries
(B) a single city
(C) two countries
(D) three countries

54. Which of the following countries is NOT a member of BRICS as represented at the 2026 summit?

(A) Ethiopia
(B) Indonesia
(C) Nigeria
(D) Egypt

D. SCIENCE, SPACE AND TECHNOLOGY

55. Who is the Chairman of the Indian Space Research Organisation?

(A) A. S. Kiran Kumar
(B) S. Somanath
(C) V. Narayanan
(D) K. Sivan

56. GSLV-F18, launched on 30 October 2026, carried which satellite?

(A) Aditya-L2
(B) NVS-03, a navigation satellite
(C) EOS-08, an earth observation satellite
(D) GSAT-20, a communications satellite

57. ISRO's first uncrewed mission under the Gaganyaan programme is intended to:

(A) place a space station module in orbit
(B) study the sun from the L1 point
(C) land a rover near the lunar south pole
(D) test the crew module and escape systems before a crewed flight

58. The target year set by India for commissioning the Bharatiya Antariksh Station is:

(A) 2028
(B) 2030
(C) 2035
(D) 2040

59. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physiology or Medicine was awarded for:

(A) work on protein structure prediction
(B) the discovery of light-gated ion channels and optogenetics
(C) the development of mRNA vaccines
(D) the discovery of the hepatitis C virus

60. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Physics was awarded to Francis Halzen for:

(A) the invention of the blue LED
(B) the detection of gravitational waves
(C) the IceCube Neutrino Observatory and high-energy astrophysical neutrinos
(D) work on black holes

61. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Chemistry recognised work on:

(A) non-linear effects and autocatalysis in asymmetric synthesis
(B) lithium-ion batteries
(C) quantum dots
(D) click chemistry

62. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Literature was awarded to:

(A) Abdulrazak Gurnah
(B) Anne Carson
(C) Han Kang
(D) Jon Fosse

63. The 2026 Nobel Peace Prize was awarded to Navi Pillay for:

(A) work on climate finance
(B) efforts to promote peace and international law
(C) reporting on conflict zones
(D) work on disarmament

64. The 2026 Nobel Prize in Economic Sciences was awarded for work that produced:

(A) New Keynesian models of macroeconomic stabilisation
(B) the efficient markets hypothesis
(C) the theory of asymmetric information
(D) the theory of comparative advantage

E. ENVIRONMENT AND CLIMATE

65. COP31 in Antalya is expected to launch which formal process under the Paris Agreement?

(A) the first global stocktake
(B) the second global stocktake
(C) the Kyoto second commitment period
(D) the loss and damage fund

66. The mascot of COP31 is:

(A) Caretta, a loggerhead turtle
(B) a flamingo
(C) an olive branch
(D) a snow leopard

67. The pre-COP ministerial meeting held in October 2026, ahead of COP31, took place in:

(A) Geneva
(B) Nairobi
(C) New York
(D) the Pacific, hosted with Fiji, Tuvalu and Australia

68. According to the United Nations, 2026 was a year in which scientists confirmed that the world is on track to:

(A) stay within 1.5 degrees Celsius of pre-industrial levels
(B) exceed the 1.5 degrees Celsius warming threshold
(C) reverse warming trends
(D) meet all Paris Agreement targets

69. Which climate phenomenon was expected to intensify impacts in 2026 and into the COP31 period?

(A) La Nina
(B) El Nino
(C) the Indian Ocean Dipole
(D) the North Atlantic Oscillation

70. The UN Framework Convention on Climate Change, the parent treaty of the Paris Agreement, was adopted in:

(A) 2009
(B) 1987
(C) 1992
(D) 1997

71. The Paris Agreement, under which countries submit nationally determined contributions, was adopted in:

(A) 2012
(B) 2015
(C) 2019
(D) 2009

72. The number of Parties to the UNFCCC is:

(A) 187
(B) 197
(C) 167
(D) 177

73. COP30, held in 2025, took place in:

(A) Dubai, UAE
(B) Glasgow, United Kingdom
(C) Baku, Azerbaijan
(D) Belem, Brazil

74. Which greenhouse gas contributes the largest share of human-caused warming?

(A) Methane
(B) Carbon dioxide
(C) Nitrous oxide
(D) Sulphur hexafluoride

F. AWARDS, HONOURS AND CULTURE

75. The Nobel Prizes were established by the will of Alfred Nobel, drawn up in:

(A) 1901
(B) 1911
(C) 1867
(D) 1895

76. The first Nobel Prizes were awarded in:

(A) 1901
(B) 1918
(C) 1945
(D) 1895

77. The Nobel Peace Prize is awarded by:
(A) the Nobel Assembly at Karolinska Institutet
(B) the Swedish Academy
(C) the Norwegian Nobel Committee
(D) the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences

78. The Nobel Prize in Literature is awarded by:
(A) the Swedish Academy
(B) the Nobel Foundation
(C) the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences
(D) the Nobel Assembly

79. The prize in Economic Sciences differs from the other Nobel Prizes because it:
(A) is decided by the Norwegian Parliament
(B) was established in 1968 by Sweden's central bank in memory of Nobel
(C) is awarded only in even years
(D) carries no cash award

80. Each 2026 Nobel Prize carried prize money of:
(A) 12 million Swedish kronor
(B) 15 million Swedish kronor
(C) 8 million Swedish kronor
(D) 10 million Swedish kronor

81. The Nobel Prizes are presented every year on 10 December, which is:
(A) the anniversary of Alfred Nobel's death
(B) the founding day of the Nobel Foundation
(C) the day the will was opened
(D) Alfred Nobel's birthday

82. Garba of Gujarat was inscribed on the UNESCO Representative List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in:
(A) 2025
(B) 2016
(C) 2019
(D) 2023

83. Which Indian festival was inscribed on the UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage list in 2025?
(A) Deepavali
(B) Onam
(C) Pongal
(D) Durga Puja

84. The multinational nomination on henna, listed for examination in the 2026 cycle, was submitted by:
(A) UNESCO member states collectively
(B) seventeen countries including India
(C) India alone
(D) five South Asian countries

G. SPORT

85. Which country won the ICC Men's T20 World Cup 2026?
(A) Australia
(B) New Zealand
(C) India
(D) South Africa

86. India won the 2026 T20 World Cup final by a margin of:

(A) 7 wickets
(B) 26 runs
(C) 56 runs
(D) 96 runs

87. India's 2026 T20 World Cup win was notable because India became:

(A) the youngest team to win the title
(B) the first host nation to lose a final
(C) the first team to win the title at home and the first to defend it
(D) the first team to win three titles in a row

88. The 2026 Asian Games were held in:

(A) Doha, Qatar
(B) Hangzhou, China
(C) Aichi-Nagoya, Japan
(D) Jakarta, Indonesia

89. India finished the 2026 Asian Games with 85 medals, which placed it:

(A) fifth
(B) second
(C) third
(D) fourth

90. India secured fourth place ahead of Uzbekistan because:

(A) the host nation broke the tie
(B) India won more gold medals
(C) India won more silver medals
(D) India won the hockey final

91. India's men's hockey team won the 2026 Asian Games gold by defeating:

(A) Japan
(B) Pakistan
(C) Malaysia
(D) South Korea

92. Which country topped the medal table at the 2026 Asian Games?

(A) South Korea
(B) India
(C) Japan
(D) China

93. The next edition of the Asian Games, in 2030, will be held in:

(A) Bangkok
(B) Riyadh
(C) Doha
(D) Dubai

94. The 2026 Winter Olympic Games were held in:

(A) Beijing, China
(B) Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo, Italy
(C) PyeongChang, South Korea
(D) Sapporo, Japan

95. Which country topped the medal table at the 2026 Winter Olympics, setting records for golds and total medals?

(A) Norway
(B) Germany
(C) Italy
(D) United States

96. Johannes Hoesflot Klaebo's achievement at the 2026 Winter Games was that he:

(A) became the oldest medallist in Winter Games history
(B) won medals in three different sports
(C) carried the flag at the opening ceremony
(D) won six gold medals in cross-country skiing, the most by any athlete at a single Winter Games

97. The closing ceremony of the 2026 Winter Olympics was held in:

(A) Milan
(B) Cortina d'Ampezzo
(C) Verona
(D) Turin

98. Which country won the 2026 FIFA World Cup?

(A) Argentina
(B) France
(C) Spain
(D) Brazil

99. Who scored the winning goal in the 2026 World Cup final?

(A) Nico Williams
(B) Ferran Torres
(C) Lamine Yamal
(D) Alvaro Morata

100. The 2026 World Cup final was played in an expanded format in which the number of teams and matches were:

(A) 48 teams and 104 matches
(B) 48 teams and 64 matches
(C) 32 teams and 64 matches
(D) 40 teams and 80 matches

ANSWER KEY

One mark for each correct answer. There is no negative marking in this set.

Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A
1	B	2	A	3	D	4	C	5	A
6	B	7	D	8	A	9	A	10	C
11	D	12	D	13	A	14	A	15	D
16	A	17	B	18	D	19	D	20	C
21	A	22	B	23	D	24	A	25	A
26	B	27	C	28	D	29	C	30	C
31	D	32	C	33	C	34	A	35	B
36	D	37	D	38	B	39	D	40	A
41	B	42	C	43	B	44	B	45	A
46	B	47	C	48	C	49	A	50	D
51	D	52	A	53	D	54	C	55	C
56	B	57	D	58	C	59	B	60	C
61	A	62	B	63	B	64	A	65	B
66	A	67	D	68	B	69	B	70	C
71	B	72	B	73	D	74	B	75	D
76	A	77	C	78	A	79	B	80	A
81	A	82	D	83	A	84	B	85	C
86	D	87	C	88	C	89	D	90	C
91	C	92	D	93	C	94	B	95	A
96	D	97	C	98	C	99	B	100	A

EXPLANATIONS

1. (B) General N. S. Raja Subramani became the third CDS on 31 May 2026; General Dhiraj Seth took over as Army chief on 30 June.

2. (A) Air Chief Marshal Ashutosh Dixit took charge as the 29th Chief of the Air Staff on 31 October 2026, succeeding Air Chief Marshal A. P. Singh.

3. (D) Admiral Krishna Swaminathan took over as the 27th Chief of the Naval Staff on 31 May 2026, the same day as the new CDS.

4. (C) General Dhiraj Seth took charge as the 31st Chief of the Army Staff on 30 June 2026.

5. (A) Justice Surya Kant is the 53rd Chief Justice of India, having taken office in November 2025.

6. (B) Sanjay Malhotra is the 26th Governor of the RBI and chairs the Monetary Policy Committee.

7. (D) Gyanesh Kumar is the 26th Chief Election Commissioner. The Election Commission conducts elections to Parliament, State legislatures and the offices of President and Vice-President.

8. (A) Arvind Panagariya chairs the Sixteenth Finance Commission, which recommended retaining the States' vertical share of central taxes at 41 per cent.

9. (A) Suvendu Adhikari was sworn in on 9 May 2026 after the BJP won 207 of the 294 seats, ending Trinamool Congress rule since 2011.

10. (C) Actor-politician C. Joseph Vijay of the Tamilaga Vettri Kazhagam was sworn in on 10 May 2026 after his party won 108 seats in the 234-member Assembly.

11. (D) Elections in 2026 were held in West Bengal, Tamil Nadu, Kerala and Assam, and in Puducherry. Karnataka was not among them.

12. (D) The Congress-led United Democratic Front won the 2026 Kerala election, dislodging the Left Democratic Front.

13. (A) He was sworn in for a second consecutive term on 12 May 2026, the first non-Congress Chief Minister in Assam to do so.

14. (A) The census is conducted under the Census Act, 1948, with rules framed under it; the Census (Amendment) Rules, 2026 widened who may be appointed an enumerator.

15. (D) 1 March 2027 is the reference date for the whole country, except Ladakh and snow-bound areas, where it is 1 October 2026.

16. (A) 'Pragati' (female) and 'Vikas' (male) were unveiled as mascots, symbolising equal participation of women and men.

17. (B) The decision was taken by the Cabinet Committee on Political Affairs on 30 April 2025; caste will be enumerated in the second phase.

18. (D) It is the first digital census, with a 15-day self-enumeration window preceding the house-to-house listing phase.

19. (D) The 101st Constitutional Amendment Act, 2016 inserted Article 279A, creating the GST Council and enabling GST from 1 July 2017.

20. (C) C. P. Radhakrishnan took office as Vice-President in September 2025, succeeding Jagdeep Dhankhar.

21. (A) The 63rd MPC meeting, held from 5 to 7 October 2026, raised the repo rate to 5.50 per cent - the first increase in nearly four years.

22. (B) The Committee changed its stance to 'calibrated tightening', having previously held a neutral stance.

23. (D) The SDF rate is set 25 basis points below the repo rate, at 5.25 per cent, while the MSF rate and Bank Rate stand at 5.75 per cent.

24. (A) Q1 of 2026-27 recorded 7.8 per cent growth, higher than expected, as noted in the October 2026 monetary policy statement.

25. (A) The projection for 2026-27 was raised to 7.1 per cent, reflecting strong net exports, government consumption and investment.

26. (B) Reserves were about USD 734.6 billion as on 2 October 2026, having peaked at about USD 785.7 billion in early September.

27. (C) The fiscal deficit was estimated at 4.3 per cent of GDP for 2026-27, against 4.4 per cent in the Revised Estimates for 2025-26.

28. (D) Public capex was increased to Rs. 12.2 lakh crore for FY 2026-27, from Rs. 11.2 lakh crore in the 2025-26 Budget Estimates.

29. (C) Debt was estimated at 55.6 per cent of GDP for 2026-27, with a target of 50 plus or minus 1 per cent by 2030-31.

30. (C) On the Sixteenth Finance Commission's recommendation, the vertical devolution share was retained at 41 per cent.

31. (D) The seven 'growth connectors' were Mumbai-Pune, Pune-Hyderabad, Hyderabad-Bengaluru, Hyderabad-Chennai, Chennai-Bengaluru, Delhi-Varanasi and Varanasi-Siliguri.

32. (C) NW-5 in Odisha will connect the Talcher and Angul mineral belt and Kalinga Nagar to the ports of Paradip and Dhamra.

33. (C) The Council recommended omission of section 69 of the CGST Act, removing arrest powers, and left the rate structure unchanged.

34. (A) The threshold was raised from Rs. 1 crore to Rs. 5 crore at the 57th GST Council meeting.

35. (B) The maximum general penalty was reduced to Rs. 10,000, and no notice is to be issued where the tax involved is Rs. 10,000 or less.

36. (D) The Council said rate changes would be considered once a year, having left the existing rate structure unchanged in October 2026.

37. (D) The period for acknowledging refund claims was cut to 10 days, one of several trade-facilitation measures at the 57th meeting.

38. (B) It was the first Budget prepared in Kartavya Bhawan, the new secretariat complex that also houses the PMO.

39. (D) The Coastal Cargo Promotion Scheme aims to raise the share from 6 per cent to 12 per cent by 2047.

40. (A) Nirmala Sitharaman, Union Minister for Finance and Corporate Affairs, presented the Budget.

41. (B) India hosted the 18th Summit at Bharat Mandapam in New Delhi on 12 and 13 September 2026, under its 2026 chairship.

42. (C) India assumed the chairship on 1 January 2026, succeeding Brazil, for the fourth time after 2012, 2016 and 2021.

43. (B) The theme's four words - resilience, innovation, cooperation, sustainability - were treated as the four pillars of the presidency.

44. (B) The New Delhi Declaration was adopted at the close of the summit, covering governance reform, trade, payments and development finance.

45. (A) COP31 is being held in Antalya, Turkiye; the previous three conferences were held in Dubai (2023), Baku (2024) and Belem (2025).

46. (B) Murat Kurum was nominated President of COP31, while Chris Bowen of Australia is President of Negotiations.

47. (C) Australia leads the negotiations, and with Fiji and Tuvalu hosted the pre-COP ministerial meeting in the Pacific in October 2026.

48. (C) The 2026 SCO summit was held in Bishkek, Kyrgyzstan, where it was announced that Pakistan would take over the rotating presidency.

49. (A) Khalilur Rahman of Bangladesh presided over the 81st session, which opened in September 2026.

50. (D) Kevin Warsh took office as Fed Chair in 2026, succeeding Jerome Powell.

51. (D) Zou Jiayi of China succeeded Jin Liqun as President of the AIIB in January 2026.

52. (A) The New Delhi Declaration on AI Impact was endorsed by 88 countries and international organisations.

53. (D) It was hosted by the United States, Canada and Mexico - the first World Cup staged across three countries.

54. (C) Egypt, Ethiopia, Indonesia, Iran and the UAE are members alongside Brazil, Russia, India, China and South Africa. Nigeria is not.

55. (C) V. Narayanan is Chairman of ISRO and Secretary, Department of Space.

56. (B) GSLV-F18 carried NVS-03, a second-generation navigation satellite, restoring the NavIC constellation to four satellites.

57. (D) The G1 uncrewed mission tests the crew module, its parachutes and escape systems before Indian astronauts fly.

58. (C) The Bharatiya Antariksh Station is targeted for 2035, with the first module planned by 2028, ahead of a crewed Moon landing by 2040.

59. (B) Karl Deisseroth, Peter Hegemann and Georg Nagel were honoured for optogenetics, which allows individual nerve cells to be switched on or off with light.

60. (C) Halzen was honoured for turning a cubic kilometre of Antarctic ice into the IceCube detector and for the discovery of high-energy neutrinos of astrophysical origin.

61. (A) Henri Kagan of France and Kenso Soai of Japan were honoured for explaining how living systems came to contain one of two mirror-image forms of a molecule.

62. (B) The Canadian poet and translator Anne Carson was honoured for an oeuvre in dialogue with the classical tradition.

63. (B) Navanethem 'Navi' Pillay, the South African jurist, was honoured for her efforts to promote peace and international law.

64. (A) Robert E. Hall and Michael Woodford were honoured for the microeconomic foundations of macroeconomic stabilisation, used by central banks worldwide.

65. (B) The first global stocktake concluded in 2023; COP31 launches the second, which assesses collective progress towards long-term goals.

66. (A) Caretta, named for the loggerhead turtle that nests on Antalya's beaches, is the mascot of the conference.

67. (D) Fiji, Tuvalu and Australia partnered to host the official pre-COP and leaders' event in the Pacific in October 2026.

68. (B) The UN noted that 2026 saw catastrophic floods, heatwaves and droughts, with the world on track to exceed the 1.5 degree threshold.

69. (B) A powerful El Nino was expected to intensify climate impacts, compounding an already extreme year.

70. (C) The UNFCCC was adopted in 1992 at the Rio Earth Summit; the Paris Agreement was adopted under it in 2015.

71. (B) The Paris Agreement was adopted at COP21 in 2015 and entered into force in 2016.

72. (B) There are 197 Parties to the Convention, which is why COP31 brings together representatives of nearly every country.

73. (D) COP30 was held in Belem, Brazil, in the Amazon; COP29 was in Baku and COP28 in Dubai.

74. (B) Carbon dioxide, largely from burning fossil fuels, accounts for the largest share of warming, though methane is far more potent per molecule.

75. (D) Nobel signed his final will in 1895; the first prizes were awarded in 1901, five years after his death.

76. (A) The first awards were made in 1901, in Physics, Chemistry, Physiology or Medicine, Literature and Peace.

77. (C) Under Nobel's will the Peace Prize is decided by a Norwegian committee and presented in Oslo; the others are decided in Sweden and presented in Stockholm.

78. (A) The Swedish Academy awards the Literature prize; the Royal Swedish Academy of Sciences awards Physics, Chemistry and Economic Sciences.

79. (B) The Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel was established in 1968, not by Nobel's will.

80. (A) The 2026 prizes were worth 12 million Swedish kronor each, about USD 1.2 million.

81. (A) The ceremony is held on 10 December, the anniversary of Nobel's death in 1896.

82. (D) Garba was inscribed in 2023 at the eighteenth session held in Kasane, Botswana, and was then India's fifteenth inscription on the List.

83. (A) Deepavali was inscribed in 2025; Durga Puja in Kolkata was inscribed in 2021.

84. (B) Henna: rituals, aesthetic and social practices was submitted by seventeen countries including India, for the Committee's twenty-first session in late 2026.

85. (C) India beat New Zealand in the final at Ahmedabad on 8 March 2026 to win the title for the third time.

86. (D) India made 255 for 5 and bowled New Zealand out for 159, winning by 96 runs at the Narendra Modi Stadium.

87. (C) It was India's third T20 world title, and the first time any side had won back-to-back titles and the first win at home.

88. (C) The 20th Asian Games were held in Aichi-Nagoya, Japan, and closed on 4 October 2026.

89. (D) India finished fourth with 21 golds, 27 silvers and 37 bronzes, its tally 21 short of the 106 won at Hangzhou.

90. (C) Both countries won 21 golds; India's 27 silvers against Uzbekistan's 25 decided the ranking.

91. (C) India beat Malaysia 5-1 in the final, retaining the title and securing qualification for the Los Angeles 2028 Olympics.

92. (D) China topped the table with 341 medals, including 169 golds; host Japan was second with 269 medals.

93. (C) Doha will host the 2030 Asian Games; Riyadh is to host the 2034 edition.

94. (B) The Games ran from 6 to 22 February 2026 across Milan, Cortina d'Ampezzo and surrounding venues in northern Italy.

95. (A) Norway won 18 golds and 41 medals in all, both records, topping the table for the fourth successive Winter Games.

96. (D) His six golds were the most by any athlete at one Winter Games, and his sixth was the last medal awarded at the Games.

97. (C) The ceremony was held at the Verona Olympic Arena, a Roman amphitheatre in a city that hosted no sporting events.

98. (C) Spain beat Argentina 1-0 after extra time at the New York New Jersey Stadium on 19 July 2026, winning the title for the second time.

99. (B) Substitute Ferran Torres scored in the 106th minute, with Nico Williams providing the assist.

100. (A) The tournament was the first with 48 teams and 104 matches, up from 32 teams and 64 matches in previous editions.